

Empathic AI: Face, Gesture, and Accessibility Technologies

(1st Edition)

Opening – FG Workshop 2026
Yutong Zhou

May 25th, 2026, 13:30-17:00

<https://empai26.vercel.app/>



Empathic AI

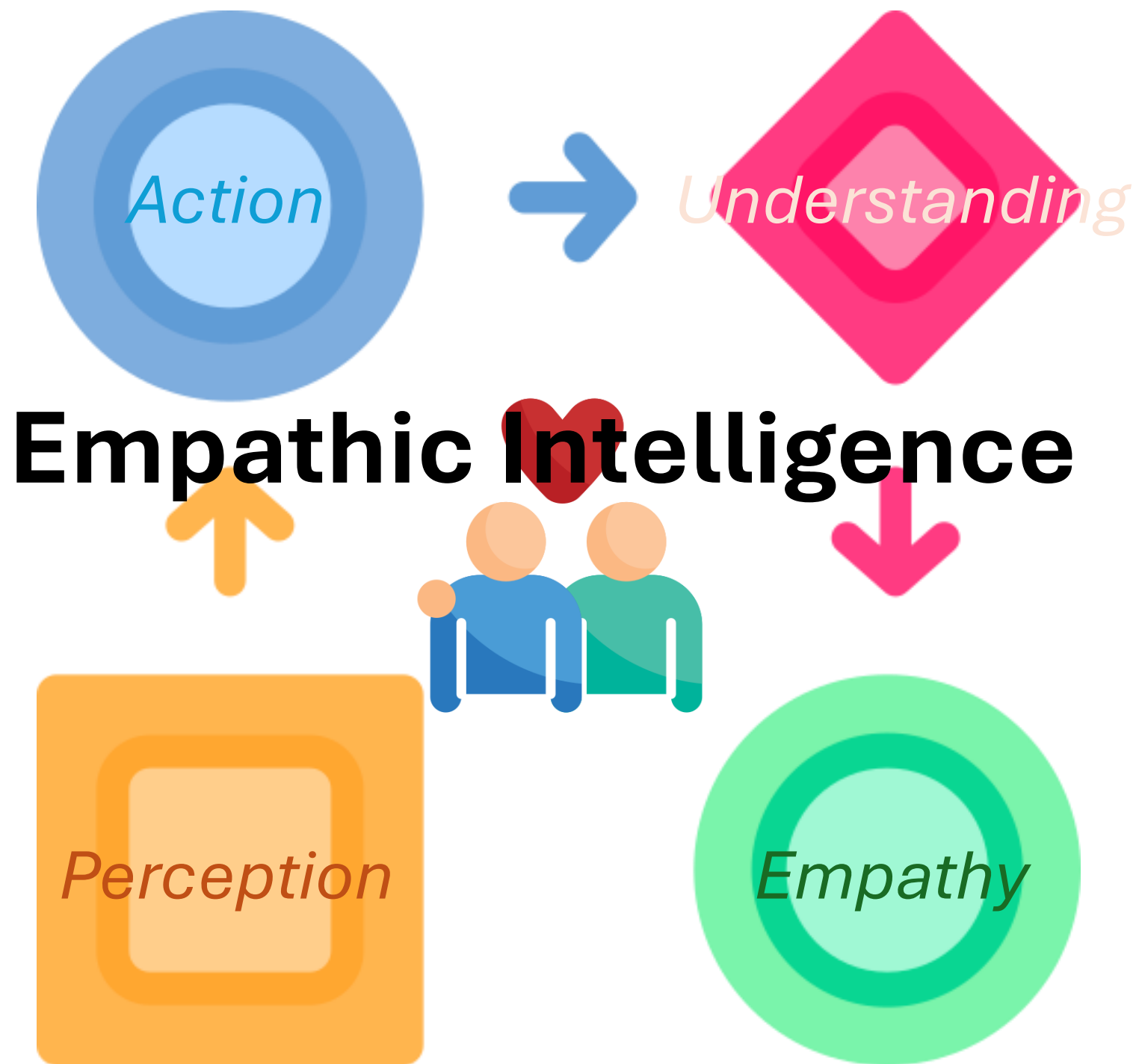


Recognition ≠ Empathy

Perception



Understanding



EmpAI Organizers



Yutong Zhou

ZALF, Germany



Von Ralph Dane Marquez Herbuela

The University of Tokyo, Japan



Haifeng Zhang

The University of Tokyo, Japan



Mariza Ferro

Fluminense Federal University, Brazil



Nobutaka Shimada

Ritsumeikan University, Japan

Today's Workshop



Keynote



Oral



Poster

From perception to **action**. From action to **understanding**.
From understanding to **inclusion**.



Tadahiro Taniguchi

Kyoto University, Japan

*Collective Predictive Coding
towards Empathic and
Symbiotic AI*



Yukie Nagai

The University of Tokyo, Japan

*Neurodiversity in Multimodal
Coordination: An Embodied
Predictive Processing
Account*



Chie Hieida

The University of Electro-
Communications, Japan

*Empathic Intelligence:
Constructing Emotions
through Vision, Physiology,
and Language*



Jiaqing Liu

Ritsumeikan University, Japan

*Interpretable Multimodal
Depression Detection via
LLM-Based Reasoning*

Invited Keynote Speakers (presentation order)

Accepted Contributions



We have **6** paper accepted!

Including: **3** oral presentations and **3** poster presentations
(**1** withdraw).

		Nidhi Sharma		
Lijun Yin		Vandana Sharma		Naser Damer
		Taoyue Wang		Eduarda Caldeira
Sorn Sooksatra		Nan Bi	Amila Akagic	
Sitapa Watcharapinchai	Sota Inoue	Fadi Boutros	Nobutaka Shimada	
	Kanita Tafro	Guray Ozgur		
THARUNIKAA P N		Shree A	Aswani Pu	

We sincerely thank all authors who submitted their papers to FG EmpAI 2026.

Thanks to all the reviewers!

- We invited 26 reviewers, finally received **20** reviewer's comments.
- Each reviewer was assigned to **1-2 papers (mostly 1)** to reduce workload.
- Each paper received an average of **4** review comments.

- | | |
|----------------------|---------------------|
| • Naser Damer | • Ambareesh Revanur |
| • Kiran Chhatre | • Fadi Boutros |
| • Yoon Kyung Lee | • Alam Noor |
| • Sen Fang | • Lucia Cascone |
| • Karine Levonyan | • Henglin Shi |
| • Yasutomo Kawanishi | • Albert Ali Salah |
| • Yassine Ouzar | • Sayde King |
| • Rachael Jack | • Zahid Akhtar |
| • Xin Wei | • Stefano Berretti |
| • Huakun Liu | • Lijun Yin |

Outstanding Reviewers

- Albert Ali Salah (Utrecht University)
- Lijun Yin (State University of New York at Binghamton)
- Rachael Jack (University of Glasgow)





**Welcome to
Empathic AI 2026!**



- This workshop is not about technology alone.
- **But about redefining who AI is built for.**